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To any Lady who will send us Six Annual Subscribers, we will send one copy of our Magazine, gratis, for one year.

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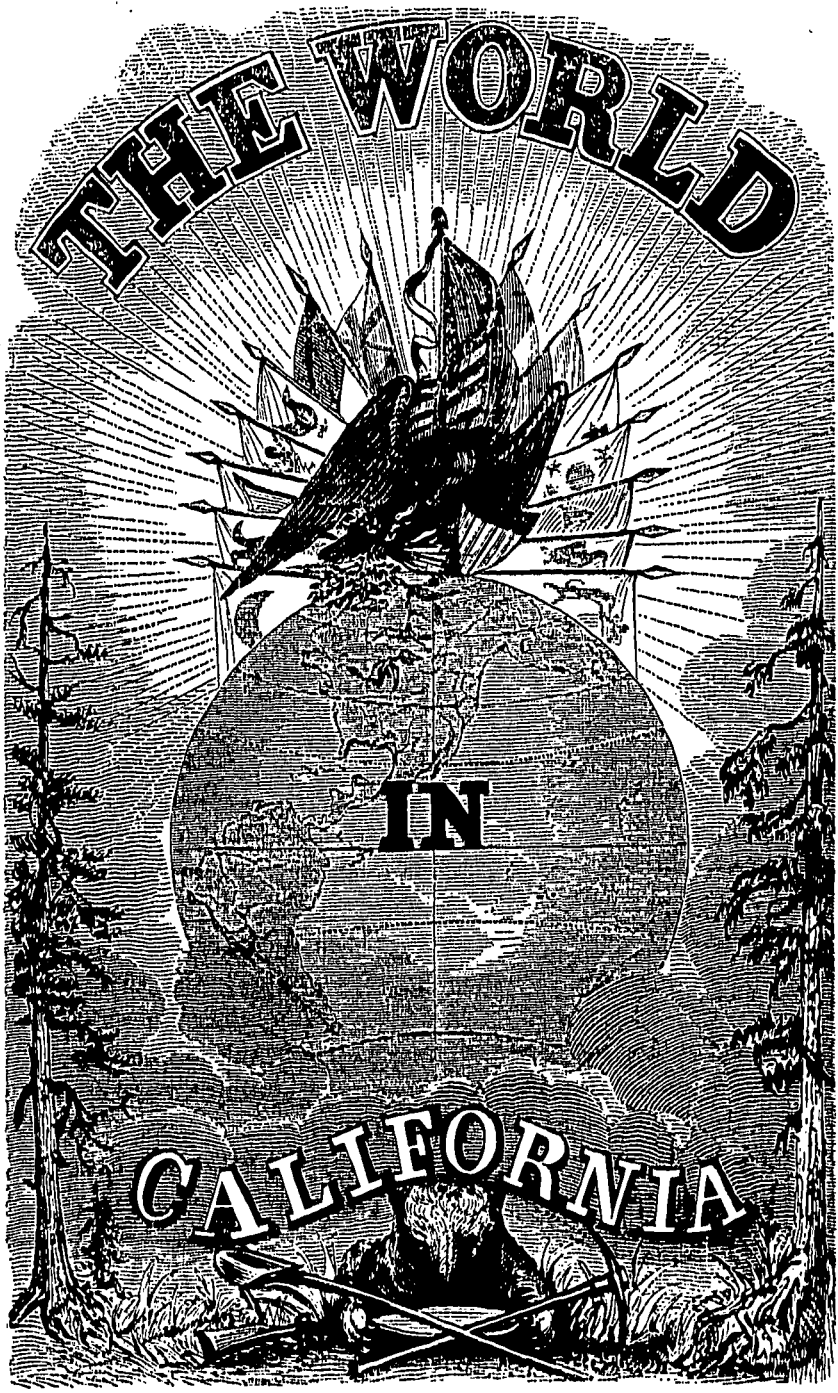
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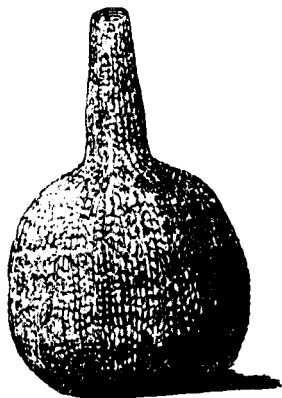
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VOL. I.

FEBRUARY, 1857.

NO. VIII.





THE INDIAN WOMAN OF SAN NICHOLAS.

Our readers will remember that in the November number of the Magazine we were favored by Capt. C. J. W. Russell, with the narrative of a woman who was eighteen years alone, on the Island of San Nicholas. Since the publication of that sketch, Capt. R. has paid a visit to Santa Barbara, and by Mr. George Nedever, the gentleman who discovered her, was presented with a water-bottle made of grass, and a stone mortar, necklace and other things that were made by her during her long and solitary residence. The water-bottle explains its own use. The mortar was used for pounding the *aulone*, the *Haliotis* of naturalists, and which was one of the principal articles of food among the Indians, and by whom they were dried for winter use, and afterwards pounded in a mortar before eating.

At the present time there are no less than twelve schooners and sloops chartered by Chinamen; besides several hundred of Chinese laborers engaged in this business, as they are an important article of consumption to China-

men in California, in addition to the vast quantities exported by them to their native land. In flavor these are said to be fully equal to the oyster, especially in soup, and could be introduced advantageously for our own use, and we would suggest to epicures here, to give this dish of "John's" a trial, for it may be possible that although we might not relish cooked rats, the *aulone* may be one of the greatest of delicacies to our own people.

(The *aulone* is the fish taken from the pearl oyster.)

The necklace made by this ingenious woman, was of slate, and although rude, it was prized by her as a great ornament, even though no one was near to admire or praise her.

There is upon this island a good sized cave in which she took up her abode, and on the walls of which she had kept a rude record of all the vessels that had passed the island, and of all the most remarkable occurrences in her lonely history, such as seeing large quantities of seals, hailing of vessels in the distance, &c.

By her signs she represented herself as once being very sick, and had to crawl upon her hands and knees from the cave to some water. During her sickness at Mr. Nedever's, although she suffered much, she never complained, and made them understand that she should like to die, for then she should meet her child in the spirit land.

We append the following interesting extract from the *Santa Barbara Gazette*.

"All that was known of this remarkable woman, and all of her history while living upon this island, she

was able to impart by signs and gestures, (she had lost the knowledge of language), and the manner of her discovery and deliverance, her arrival here and death that soon followed, has before been published. While living she was an object of lively interest to some and curiosity to others.

"Speaking with a friend lately, an old and respectable resident of California, on this and kindred topics, we were enabled to trace the history of the Indians inhabiting this and other islands in our channel back to the year 1811. The account given of the war of extermination* against the Indians on this particular island is not uninteresting, and runs thus:

"In the year 1811, a ship† owned by Boardman & Pope, of Boston, commanded by Capt. Whittemore, trading on this coast, took from the port of Sitka, Russian America, about thirty Kodiak Indians, a part of a hardy tribe inhabiting the island of Kodiak, to the islands in the Santa Barbara Channel, for the purpose of killing sea otter, which were then very numerous in the neighborhood of these islands. Capt. Whittemore, after landing the Kodiaks on the island, and placing in their hands fire-arms and the necessary implements of the chase, sailed away to the coast of Lower California, and South America.

"In the absence of the ship, a dispute arose between the Kodiaks and the natives of the islands, originating in the seizure of the females by the Kodiaks. The Kodiaks possessing more activity, endurance and knowledge of war, and possessing superior weapons, slaughtered the males without mercy, old and young. On the island of San Nicholas, not a male, old or young, was spared. At the end of a year Capt. Whittemore returned to

the islands, took the Kodiaks on board, and carried them back to Sitka.

"From this period little is known of the Indians remaining on these islands till the year 1836, when Capt. Isaac Williams, late Collector of the Port or San Pedro, visited this island in a small vessel, and took on board all the Indians remaining but one woman, who was left in the manner stated by Capt. Russell, in the *California Magazine*. The Indians of the islands were of the type of the coast Indians, and were no doubt a part of them."

I WILL BE GOOD TO-DAY.

"I will be good, dear mother,"

I heard a sweet child say;

"I will be good; now watch me;

I will be good all day."

She lifted up her bright young eyes,

With a soft and pleasing smile;

Then a mother's kiss was on her lips—

So pure and free from guile.

And, when night came, that little one,

In kneeling down to pray,

Said, in a soft and whispering tone,

"Have I been good to-day?"

Oh, many, many bitter tears

'Twould save us, did we say,

Like that dear child, with earnest heart,

"I will be good to-day."

Too Good to be Lost.—An old miser in New England owning a farm, found it impossible to do his work without assistance, and accordingly offered any man food for performing the requisite labor. A half starved pauper hearing of the terms, accepted them. Before going into the fields in the morning, the farmer invited his help to breakfast; after finishing the morning meal, the old skin-flint thought it would be saving time if they should place the dinner upon the breakfast. This was readily agreed to by the unsatisfied stranger, and the dinner was soon despatched.

"Suppose, now," said the frugal farmer "we take supper, it will save time and trouble, you know."

"Just as you like it," said the eager eater, and at it they went.

"Now we will go to work," said the satisfied and delighted employer.

"Thank you," said the delighted laborer, "I never work after supper."

* The war referred to by Capt. Russell in the *Cal. Mag.* of Nov.

† The ship was captured the following year near the Sandwich Islands, by the British ship-of-war "Phoebe," and Capt. Whittemore was carried a prisoner of war to England.—Ed.